

Get the whole group to **BeThere.**

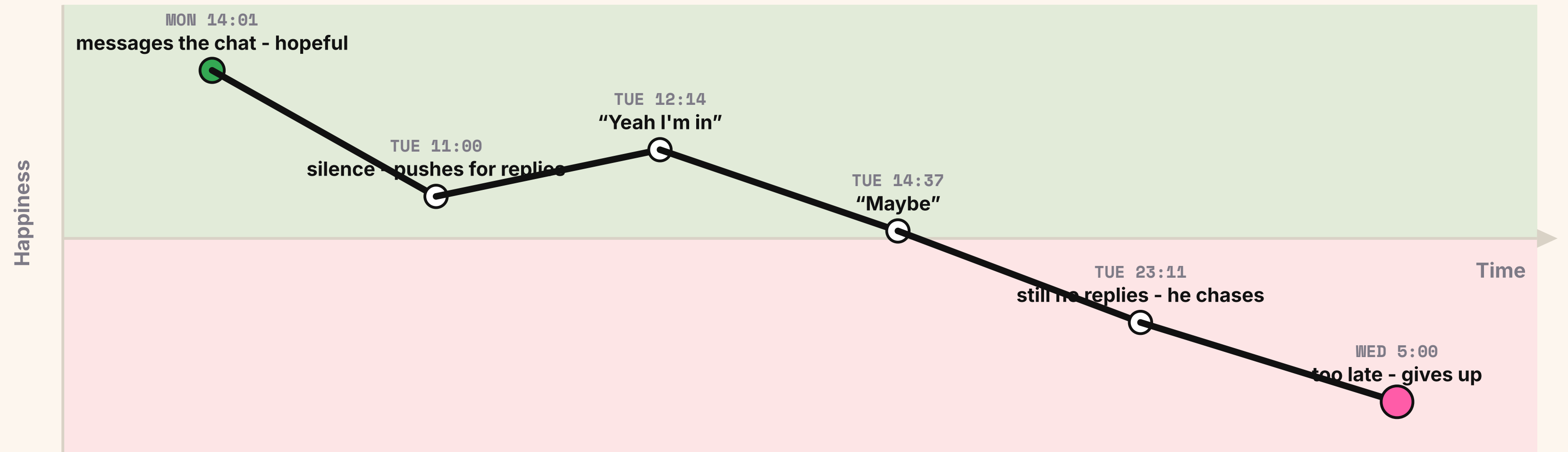
No organiser. No maybe - just the whole group, there.

Meet **Vasanth**

- Age 21
- Studies Law at St. Andrews
- Enjoys playing volleyball and board games
- Loves to cook for his friends
- Extroverted and reliable



Vasanth's Christmas break, mapped as he felt it



THE ORGANISER'S PROBLEM

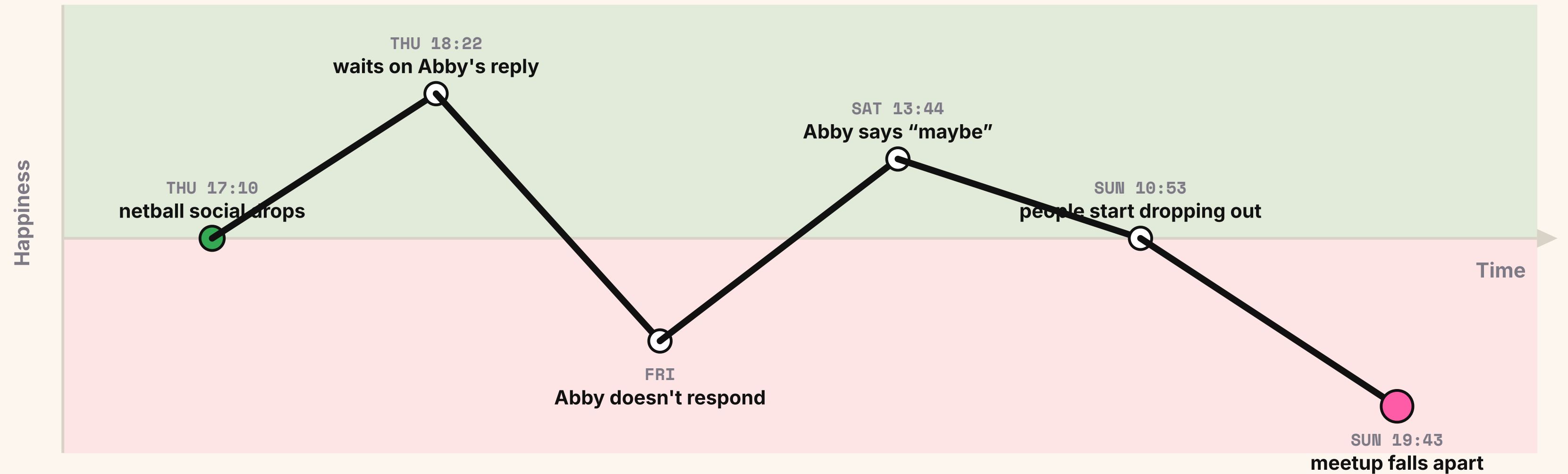
Vasanth loves to meet his friends, but organising is difficult and chasing replies from hesitant group members is frustrating.

Meet **Milly**

- Age 19
- Studies English Literature at St. Andrews
- Likes to play cello and read
- Recently joined her university's netball society
- Shy and introverted



Milly's netball social, mapped as she felt it



THE PARTICIPANT'S PROBLEM

Milly would love to engage with her netball society's socials more, but she is *hesitant* because she wants to be sure her friends are *going too*.

RESEARCH

To better understand this problem, we interviewed
university students **about their social lives.**



Eddie, 21

Psychology · Goldsmiths

The organiser

“If I drummed up the plan, and it’s taken **considerable time** - logistics, pricing, whether everyone’s okay with it - and then it falls through after all of that, that’s **quite frustrating.**”



Chloe, 19

Int. Relations · King's
College

The participant

“As days went past, the meetup got **more drawn out**, second thoughts crept in, and more and more people ended up **pulling out**.”



Luca, 20
BioChem · Oxford

The conditional

“If I’m meeting a friend of a friend, my attendance is **conditional** on my friend being there. I’ll **wait for them to respond first**, then decide.”

Two key stakeholder **groups**

1. SUGGESTORS

One sided and exhausting. *Awkward* to push for replies.

2. PARTICIPANTS

Uncertainty *compounds* uncertainty. Some people's participation is *contingent* on others.

The most connected generation - and the loneliest

70%

less time 15-24s spend with friends in person than two decades ago.

US Surgeon General, 2023

40%

of UK 16-24s feel lonely often or very often - the loneliest age group.

BBC Loneliness Experiment, 2018

76%

of young adults say seeing friends is how they look after their wellbeing.

ONS, Social Trends, 2025

Plans dying is the **norm**

We surveyed 47 people about how they plan meet-ups.

87%

send a “maybe” or delay their reply to a plan they are unsure about.

60%

say the meet-up time gets moved half the time or more.

50%+

say over a third of their meet-ups never make it out of the chat.

Almost nobody gives a **straight answer**

"When you are only slightly unsure you can make a plan, what do you send?" · n=47

A "maybe" or delay

87%

A clear yes / no

13%

OPPORTUNITY - HOW MIGHT WE

How might we reduce **hesitancy in undergraduate friend groups when planning to meet up so that groups go from frustrating **'maybe'** responses to a clear **consensus**?**

User Story

As a social member of my friend group who tends to organise things

I want to be able to easily suggest meetups to my friends

So that I can see my friends more without the frustration of chasing responses



Our initial design

Suggesting a meet - what we tried, and what testers told us

TRY 1 · SUGGEST A MEET

<

Suggest a meet

GROUP

Lithuanian Study Group

Climbing Group

TITLE

Bouldering

LOCATION

Vauxwall East

DATE

2026-06-10

TIME

14:00

Create

Meetups

Groups

Account

“I could see this being used to just check for people's availability - sending out a vague idea of ‘I want to meetup’ and seeing what everyone wants to do.”

“Having a set time seems quite restrictive - it would be nice to agree on a time within the group.”

TRY 2 · FLEXIBLE VS FIXED TIME

20:05

<

Suggest a meet

LOCATION optional

TenPin Bexleyheath

NOTES optional

Come at 6, we'll eat around 8

WHEN

Flexible

Fixed

Offer a time or two; people react and it locks at a deadline.

Tomorrow eve

This Sat

Sat eve

Next week

Thu, Jun 4

10:15 PM

+ Add a time

LOCKS IN

Locks Wed 3 Jun, 22:15

the evening before - best-supported time wins

Change

Float it

Add a title to continue

Meetups

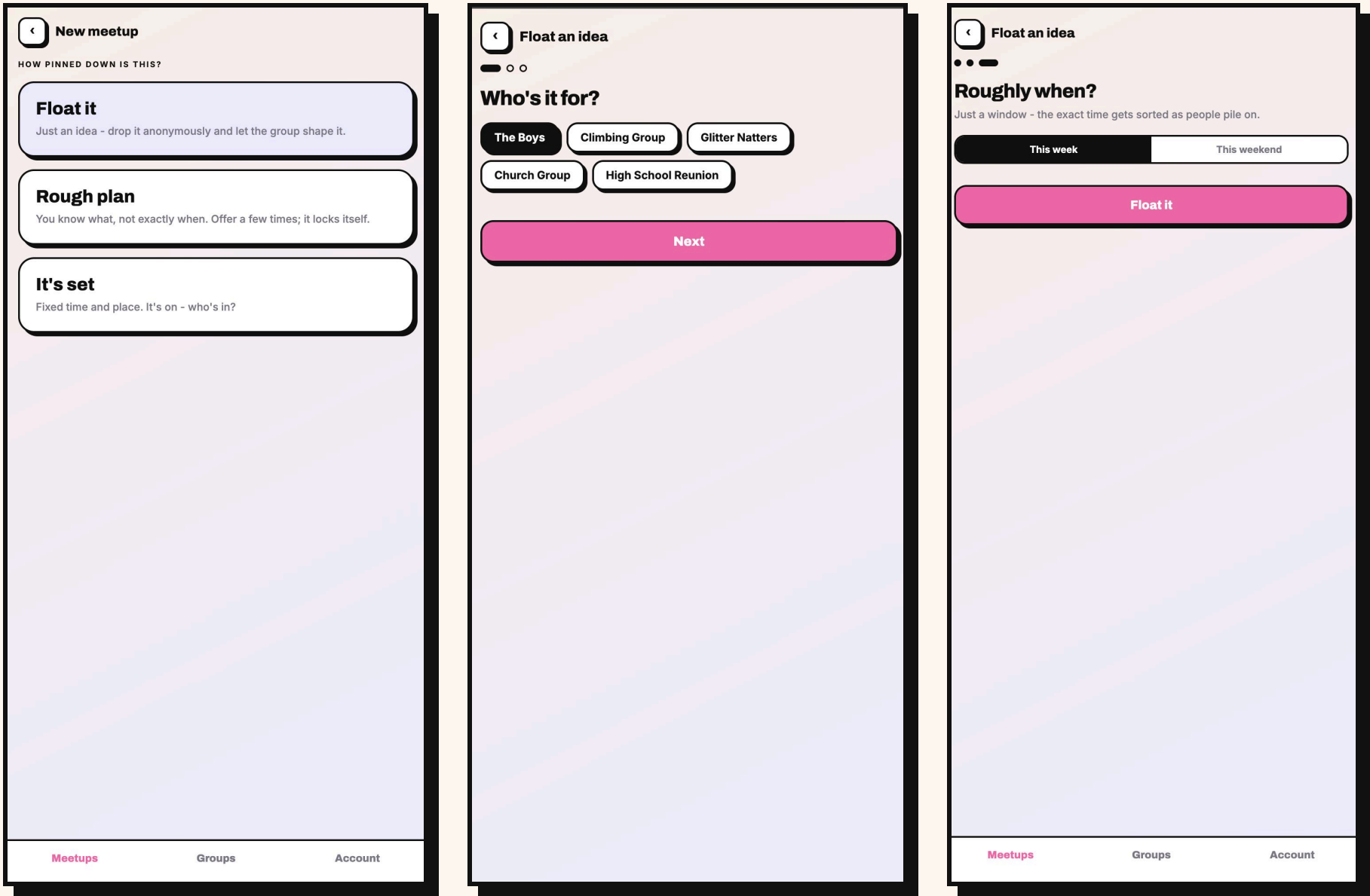
Groups

Account

“It's not immediately obvious why there's a flexible and fixed option for times.”

→ So we cut the modes down to two simple switches.

After some refinement



“
These options are quite confusing - I don't really understand when you would ever use the rough plan option.
- Aisha, 2nd year

User Story

As a new and introverted member of a friend group

I want to only attend social events if I already know people going

So that I never feel out of place



Initial mock-up

Conditional attendance - "I'll go if..."

28th May 2026

Bowling

TenPin Bowling
Bexleyheath
16:00

I will make it

I won't make it

I will make it if...

Joe

AND

...

OR

...

are going
I confirm

28th May 2026

Bowling

TenPin Bowling
Bexleyheath
16:00

I will make it

I won't make it

I will make it if...

Joe	☐	at least one of	all of
Bethan	☐		
Adi	☒	are going	
Lily	☒		
Nathan	☐		

CONFIRM

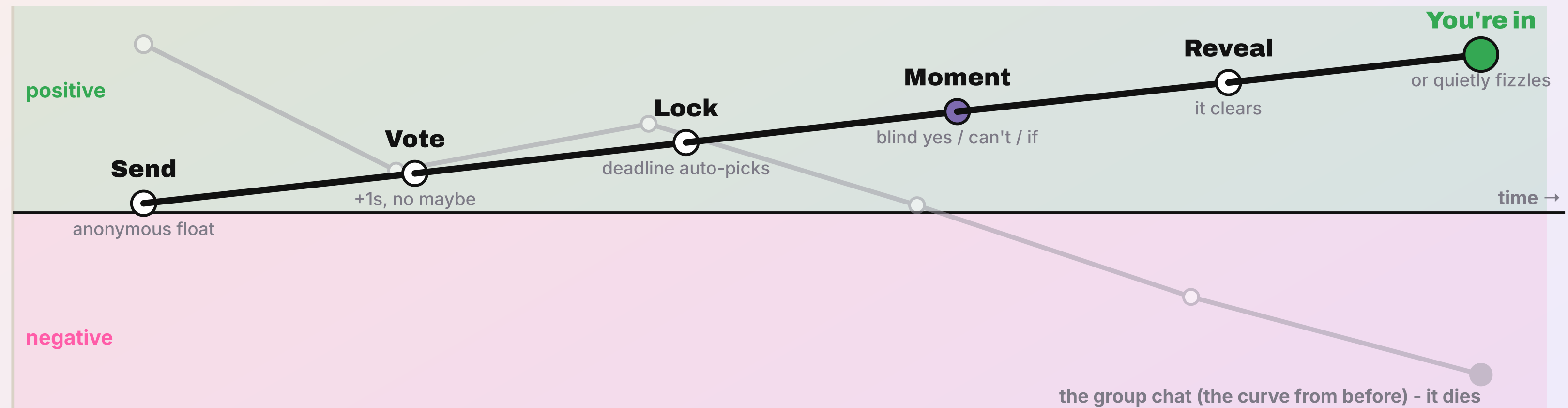
"It's either I'll go if one person goes, or if a group of people go. I don't think I'd need something this complex."

"There's gotta be an and/or type thing with the ifs - I'll go if Adi and Lily are going, or if either of them are going."

"These two options are definitely the things I'll be thinking about if it were a meeting where I'd conditionally go."

And the curve **inverts**

Same Friday, same friends. The faint line is Vasanth's journey from before - the same plan in the group chat. BeThere inverts it.



User Story

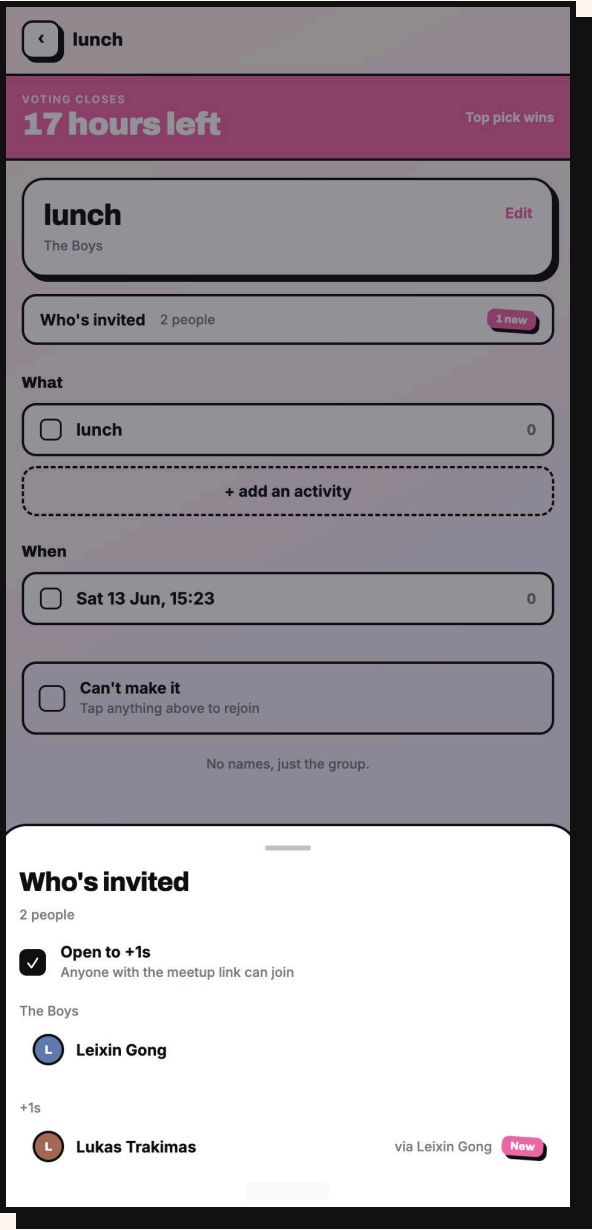
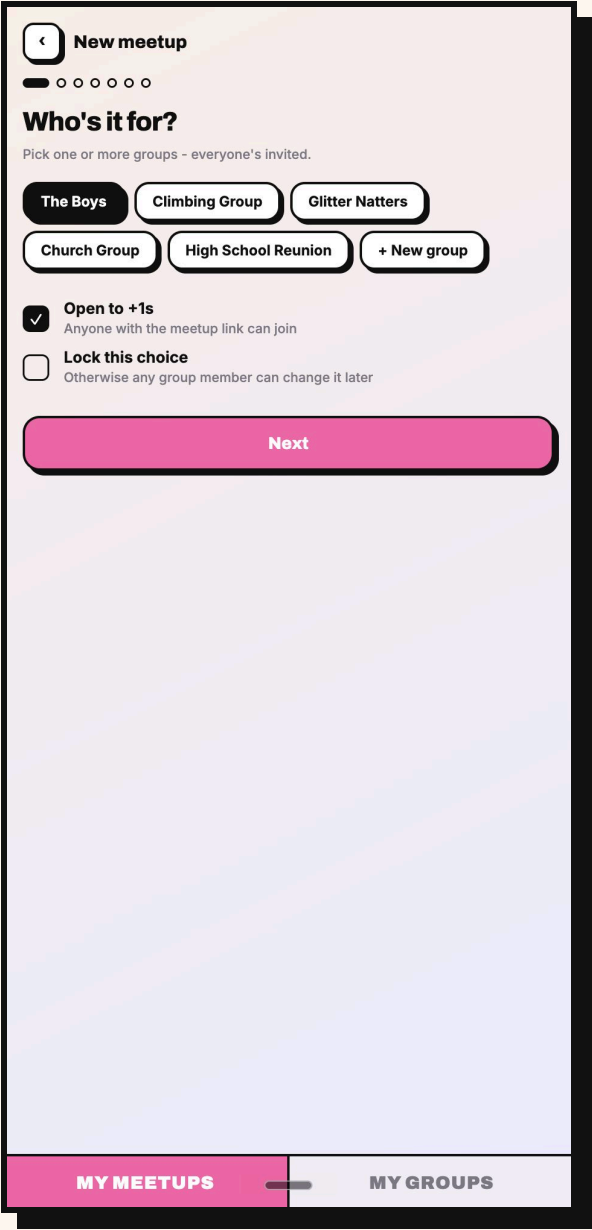
As a student in numerous friend groups

I want to suggest meetups bringing together several groups of people, and to allow friends to bring along their friends

So that I can invite people I don't know who would improve the event



After some refinement



“

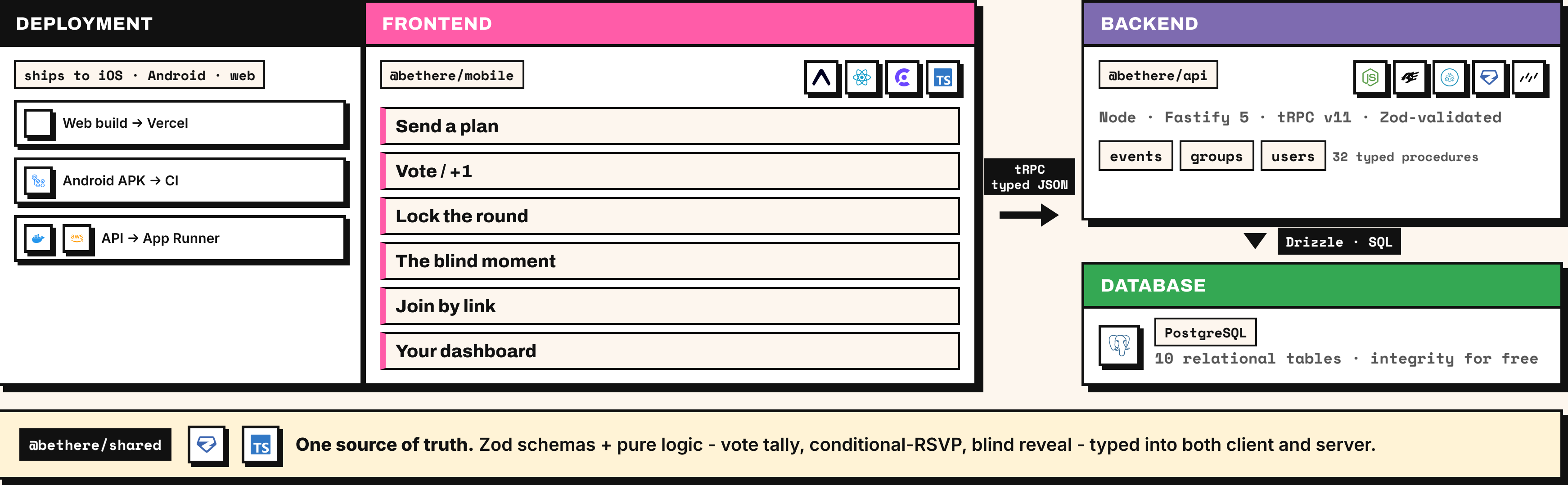
Going to a group event is a lot about the chemistry between the group. If someone was there I didn't really know, it might ruin that.

- Daniel, 3rd year

Implementation

Under the hood

One typed pnpm monorepo • TypeScript end to end



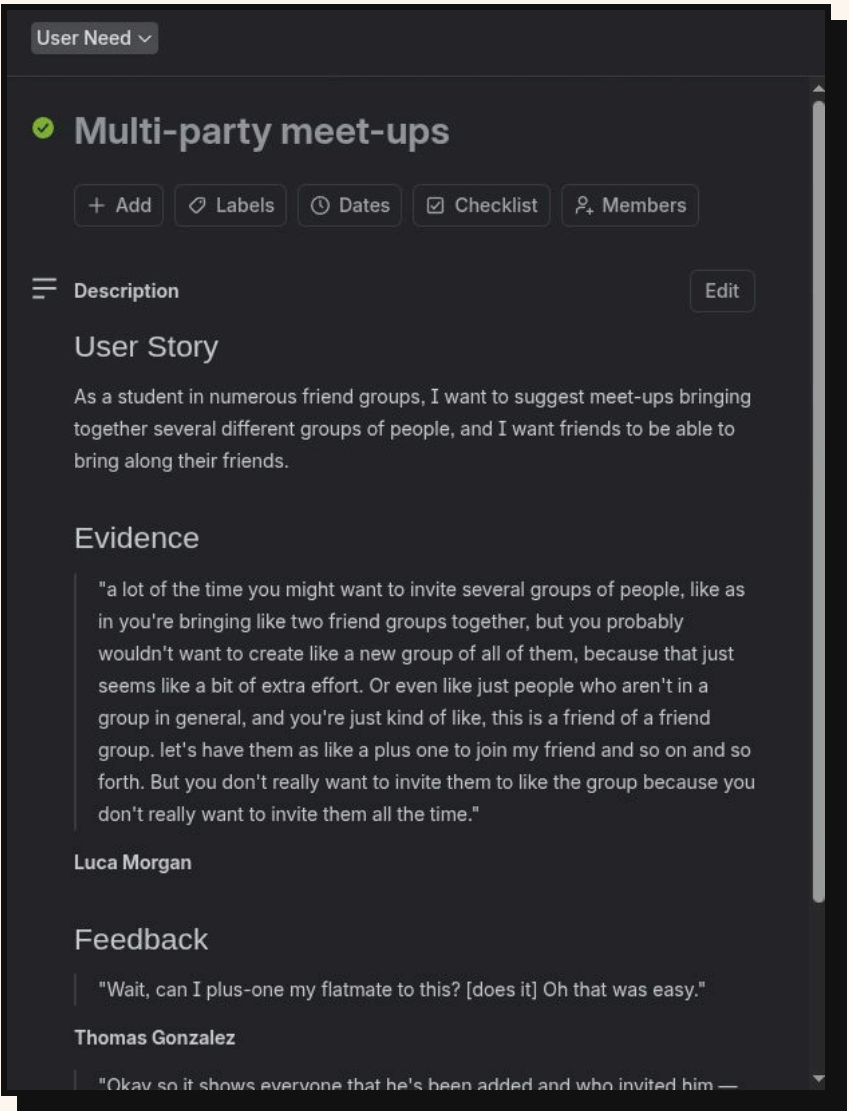
press → to walk through each layer ↓

What went well

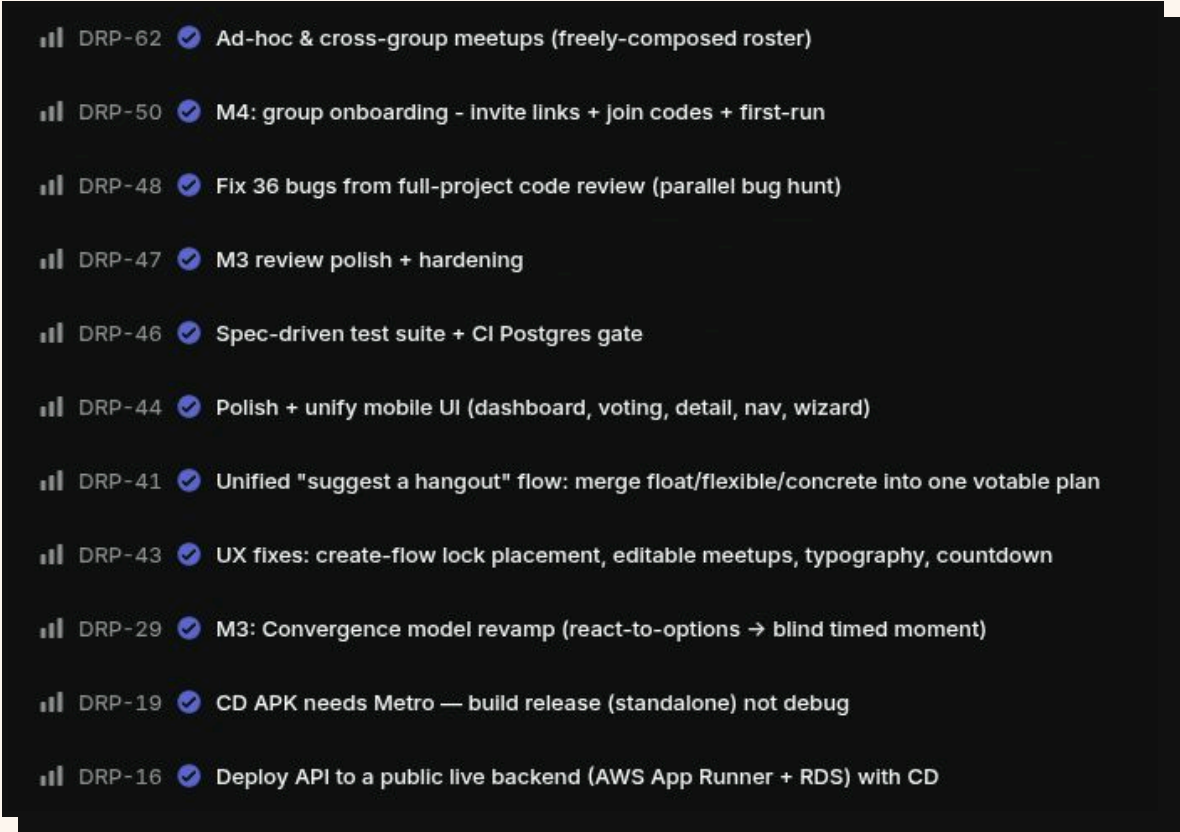
Continuous feedback from **new and **recurring** users gave us diverse insights into how the problem is actually solved.**

Letting users plan **real meetups with their friends using BeThere helped identify the pain points of the app.**

Agile development



Trello for mapping user needs.



Linear for engineering issues.

What we would do differently

Testing: a stronger test suite with wider code coverage would've prevented bugs from recurring.

Sprint planning: earlier iterations were too feature-focused - user stories were an afterthought.

Impact

User impacts & **benefits**



Vasanth

- ✓ Goes out with his friends regularly, despite his busy schedule.
- ✓ Feels less lonely.

Milly

- ✓ Is more comfortable with meeting new people.
- ✓ Has begun suggesting meetups of her own.

Wider **impacts**

If fewer plans die in the chat, the benefit ripples outward.

MENTAL HEALTH

University counselling services

Less isolation to pick up.

PUBLIC HEALTH

NHS mental health provision

Loneliness is a population-level cost.

COMMUNITY

University societies

More socials that actually happen.

LOCAL ECONOMY

Local venues

Plans that land fill seats.

Looking ahead

Availability changes

When Milly's plans change after she confirms, tell the people who said "I'll go **if Milly**" - right away.

Plus-ones, in the group's control

Vasanth can welcome a guest without the **people he'd rather not** see turn up.

A chat once it's on

A per-meetup chat that opens **only after a plan confirms** - settle details without reopening the dead chat.

BeThere

You're in

Be there - without the **organiser**

I care less about what we do. I just want to see them.

- the reason we built it

DRP · Group 02
Nelson · Lukas · Noah · James